

Ecclesiastical Latin

EL-II.8: Temporal, Causal, and Concessive Clauses

Choose mood and translation for *cum* and related conjunctions from time relation, viewpoint, asserted or reported cause, and concession

Stage	Stage II — Core Grammar
Prerequisite	EL-II.7 mastery: identify substantive-clause noun slots and governors
Next	EL-II.9, Conditions

Read *EL-GUIDE: Start Here* before using this packet. Course method, pacing, source conventions, and answer protocol are stated there; this module begins with its lesson and assumes previously taught terms.

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Part I

Lesson

CHAPTER 1

Temporal, causal, and concessive clauses

On completing this unit, you can:

- choose indicative or subjunctive with *cum* according to meaning;
- read the principal temporal conjunctions and their time relations;
- distinguish asserted cause from circumstantial or reported cause;
- recognize concession with *quamquam*, *etsi*, *licet*, and *cum*.

1.1 Mood follows viewpoint

A **temporal clause** locates one action in relation to another. A **causal clause** supplies a reason. A **concessive clause** admits a circumstance despite which the main statement remains true (“although”). The same conjunction can introduce more than one relation, so meaning and mood must be considered together.

Cum

Use	Mood	Test
temporal, definite	indicative	“when” identifies a time as a fact, especially present or repeated action
circumstantial/historical	subjunctive	supplies the background in which the main event unfolds; usually imperfect or pluperfect in past narration
causal	subjunctive	“since/because,” presenting a reason as the writer’s framing
concessive	subjunctive	“although”; main clause often has <i>tamen</i>

With indicative, *cum* may be temporal or causal when the cause is asserted as an objective fact. Translate only after testing the relation.

Other temporal and causal markers

Ubi, *ut*, *postquam* normally take indicative for a completed factual event. *Dum* + present indicative commonly means “while” even beside a past main verb; *dum* may also take subjunctive for expectation or purpose. *donec*, *quoad*, and *antequam/priusquam* take indicative for an actual fact and subjunctive when the event is anticipated, intended, or merely possible. *Simul ac* means “as soon as.”

Quia, *quoniam*, *quod* + indicative assert a cause; subjunctive can mark an alleged or reported cause. *Quamquam/etsi* generally take indicative for admitted fact; *licet* and concessive *cum* take subjunctive. *Etiam si* follows the mood of the condition it introduces.

1.2 Reading the forms in context

Worked example: historical *cum* (Matthew 2:1)

Worked passage ID: W.II.31; exact source and collation state are recorded in the passage inventory.

Cum ergo natus esset Iesus in Bethlehem Iuda in diebus Herodis regis, ecce Magi ab oriente venerunt Ierosolymam.

Analysis. Pluperfect subjunctive *natus esset* gives prior historical background to *venerunt*; it is not a contrary-to-fact condition. The clause means “after/when Jesus had been born.”

Translation. “When Jesus had therefore been born in Bethlehem of Judah in the days of King Herod, behold, Magi came from the east to Jerusalem.”

Worked example: two *dum*-clauses in a Christmas Introit

Worked passage ID: W.II.32; exact source and collation state are recorded in the passage inventory.

Dum medium silentium tenerent omnia, et nox in suo cursu medium iter haberet, omnipotens sermo tuus, Domine, de cælis a regalibus sedibus venit.

Analysis. Imperfect subjunctives *tenerent* and *haberet* frame the circumstance in which *venit* occurs. *Omnia* is the plural subject of *tenerent*; *sermo* is subject of *venit*.

Translation. “While all things held the middle silence and night held the middle of its course, your almighty Word, O Lord, came from heaven, from royal thrones.”

Worked example: anticipated time (Matthew 26:34)

Worked passage ID: W.II.33; exact source and collation state are recorded in the passage inventory.

Priusquam gallus cantet, ter me negabis.

Analysis. The cock’s crow is anticipated relative to future *negabis*; hence present subjunctive *cantet*. *Priusquam* is temporal, not a purpose marker.

Translation. “Before the cock crows, you will deny me three times.”

Worked example: concessive circumstance (2 Corinthians 8:9)

Worked passage ID: W.II.34; exact source and collation state are recorded in the passage inventory.

Propter vos egenus factus est, cum esset dives.

Analysis. *Cum esset* cannot mean simple chronological sequence here; the contrast with *egenus factus est* makes it concessive: “although he was rich.”

Translation. “For your sake he became poor, although he was rich.”

1.3 Writing laboratory

Make a four-column page headed DEFINITE TIME / BACKGROUND / CAUSE / CONCESSION. Copy each worked clause into its column and write mood, tense, and viewpoint beneath it.

Join *Christus natus est; Magi venerunt* with historical *cum*; join *gallus cantabit; Petrus negabit* with anticipated *priusquam*; concede *dives erat* before *egenus factus est*; and assert a cause with *quia*. Then change the asserted cause into a reported allegation by changing mood and explaining the new stance.

Part II

Practice

CHAPTER 1

Transfer, retrieval, and application

1.1 Mood follows viewpoint — transfer practice

Connection. A *cum* matrix separates temporal reference from circumstantial, causal, and concessive framing.

Transfer task. Build rows for temporal, circumstantial, causal, and concessive *cum*; add columns for ordinary mood, time or viewpoint, contextual signal, and possible English rendering. Fill only claims supported by the lesson.

Retrieval check. Explain why subjunctive *cum* does not automatically mean the event is unreal.

1.2 Reading the forms in context — transfer practice

Connection. Cause can be asserted by the writer or attributed to another viewpoint, and the mood helps preserve that stance.

Transfer task. For the lesson examples, label whose explanation is being presented and whether it is asserted, circumstantial, reported, or conceded. Underline the conjunction and parse the finite verb before translating.

Retrieval check. State one piece of contextual evidence, besides mood, that supports a reported-cause reading.

1.3 Writing laboratory — transfer practice

Connection. Changing an asserted cause into a reported explanation tests whether mood and discourse stance change together.

Transfer task. Perform the lesson's cause transformation. Make a before/after chart naming connective, mood, speaker commitment, and English rendering; preserve the underlying proposition.

Retrieval check. Explain what changes when stance changes and what must remain constant.

Part III

Worksheets

CHAPTER 1

Temporal, causal, and concessive clauses: parallel forms

Worksheet II.29 — Circumstance A

Worksheet ID: II.29

Focus: *cum*, temporal markers, cause, concession

Use: State both mood and the speaker's viewpoint.

1. Classify *Cum Christus natus esset, Magi venerunt.*

-
2. Choose mood: *Postquam sacerdos (venire) _____, Missa coepit.*
-

3. Join with anticipated *priusquam*: *Gallus cantabit; Petrus negabit.*
-

4. Translate the concession: *Cum dives esset, egenus factus est.*
-

5. **Text:** *Cum ergo natus esset Iesus in Bethlehem Iuda in diebus Herodis regis, ecce Magi ab oriente venerunt Ierosolymam.*

Passage ID: II.29.1; exact source and collation state are recorded in the passage inventory.

Parse the subordinate verb and translate.

6. Write one factual cause with *quia* and one circumstantial cause with *cum*.
-

Worksheet II.32 — Circumstance D**Worksheet ID:** II.32**Focus:** *cum*, temporal markers, cause, concession**Use:** State both mood and the speaker's viewpoint.

1. Classify *Cum sciret horam venisse, oravit.*

2. Translate *Simul ac vocem audivit, surrexit.*

3. Complete:

Exspectat donec ille (venire) _____; *expectavit donec ille (venire)* _____
(and he did come).

4. Correct *Licet infirmus est, tamen venit.*

5. **Text:** *Priusquam gallus cantet, ter me negabis.*

Passage ID: II.32.1; exact source and collation state are recorded in the passage inventory.

Explain mood and translate.

6. Write a sentence in which *cum* could mean “when,” then revise context so it unmistakably means “although.”

Part IV

Assessment

CHAPTER 1

Mastery assessment and record

Advance when: Choose and justify mood in at least eleven of twelve conjunction clauses, translate four values of *cum* without reducing them all to “when”, and compose one accurate example of each major relation.

Complete the assessment before opening the answer part. Record evidence, not confidence or elapsed time.

Evidence	First attempt	Delayed check
Date and conditions		
Worksheet ID and score		
Mastery task and result		
One recurring error family		
Correction stated as a rule		
Unseen or remediation item used		

If the criterion is met: continue to EL-II.9, Conditions.

If it is not met: Worksheets II.30 and II.31 remain optional remediation or delayed-recall variants.

Advance / remediate decision: _____ **Next review date:** _____

Reason in one complete sentence: _____

Part V

Answer Key

Open this part only after completing the assessment record. Use the comparison and alternative-answer protocol in EL-GUIDE.

CHAPTER 1

Practice models and rubrics

Mood follows viewpoint — model and rubric

Model / acceptable evidence. The matrix assigns indicative to straightforward temporal assertion where appropriate and subjunctive to circumstantial, causal, or concessive framing as taught. Subjunctive marks presentation or dependency here, not necessarily unreality.

Reading the forms in context — model and rubric

Model / acceptable evidence. A defensible answer identifies an attribution, speaker shift, distancing context, or governing discourse that makes the cause someone else's allegation. Mood supports but does not alone create that stance.

Writing laboratory — model and rubric

Model / acceptable evidence. The proposition and time relation remain; the presentation of the cause and ordinarily its mood change. The English should signal assertion versus attribution without adding certainty or unreality not present in the Latin construction.

CHAPTER 2

Temporal, causal, and concessive clauses: parallel forms

Solution II.29 — Circumstance A

Worksheet ID: II.29

Focus: *cum*, temporal markers, cause, concession**Use:** State both mood and the speaker's viewpoint.

1. Classify *Cum Christus natus esset, Magi venerunt*.

Answer / model: Historical/circumstantial *cum*; pluperfect subjunctive gives background prior to *venerunt*: “when/after Christ had been born.”

2. Choose mood: *Postquam sacerdos (venire) _____, Missa coepit*.

Answer / model: *venit*; *postquam* normally takes indicative for a completed factual event.

3. Join with anticipated *priusquam*: *Gallus cantabit; Petrus negabit*.

Answer / model: *Priusquam gallus cantet, Petrus negabit*. Present subjunctive presents the crow as anticipated relative to the future denial.

4. Translate the concession: *Cum dives esset, egenus factus est*.

Answer / model: “Although he was rich, he became poor.” Contrast makes imperfect subjunctive *esset* concessive.

5. **Text:** *Cum ergo natus esset Iesus in Bethlehem Iuda in diebus Herodis regis, ecce Magi ab oriente venerunt Ierosolymam*.

Passage ID: II.29.1; exact source and collation state are recorded in the passage inventory.

Parse the subordinate verb and translate.

Answer / notes: *Natus esset* is third singular pluperfect subjunctive, prior historical background. “When Jesus had therefore been born in Bethlehem of Judah in the days of King Herod, behold, Magi came from the east to Jerusalem.”

6. Write one factual cause with *quia* and one circumstantial cause with *cum*.

Answer / model: Models: *Gaudemus quia Christus resurrexit*; *cum Christus resurrexerit, gaudeamus*. The first asserts a fact; the second frames it as the reason for the exhortation, “since Christ has risen.”

Solution II.32 — Circumstance D

Worksheet ID: II.32

Focus: *cum*, temporal markers, cause, concession

Use: State both mood and the speaker's viewpoint.

1. Classify *Cum sciret horam venisse, oravit.*

Answer / model: Causal/circumstantial *cum*: “since he knew the hour had come, he prayed.” Imperfect subjunctive supplies the main event's background.

2. Translate *Simul ac vocem audivit, surrexit.*

Answer / model: “As soon as he heard the voice, he rose.” Both verbs are perfect indicative factual events.

3. Complete:

Exspectat donec ille (venire) _____; exspectavit donec ille (venire) _____ (and he did come).

Answer / model: *veniat* for the still-anticipated endpoint;

venit (perfect indicative in context) for the attained event asserted as fact.

4. Correct *Licet infirmus est, tamen venit.*

Answer / model: *Licet infirmus sit, tamen venit.* *Licet* governs subjunctive.

5. **Text:** *Priusquam gallus cantet, ter me negabis.*

Passage ID: II.32.1; exact source and collation state are recorded in the passage inventory.

Explain mood and translate.

Answer / notes: The crow is anticipated relative to future *negabis*, so *cantet* is present subjunctive. “Before the cock crows, you will deny me three times.”

6. Write a sentence in which *cum* could mean “when,” then revise context so it unmistakably means “although.”

Answer / model: Model: *Cum sacerdos oraret, populus tacebat; cum sacerdos infirmus esset, tamen Missam celebravit.*

Part VI

Scope and Sources

CHAPTER 1

Scope and Qualifications

1.1 Packet boundary

This is module EL-II.8, *Temporal, Causal, and Concessive Clauses*, in Triptych's print-first Ecclesiastical Latin curriculum. It imports one authoritative lesson, transfer practice for its internal submodules, two selected worksheets, one local mastery assessment, and matching solutions. This packet teaches operational viewpoint distinctions; context may leave more than one defensible English connective.

The unprinted worksheet variants remain course-owned extension material; their omission is intentional and is not a claim that the module exhausts available practice. EL-GUIDE owns the course-wide study method, pacing, lookup discipline, answer protocol, source classes, and advancement rules; this packet assumes that orientation and terminology taught in prerequisite modules.

1.2 Controlling records and local state

Course-wide research records own the edition, passage, answer, curriculum, and source decisions; the leaf's module map records this packet's selection and transfer practice. EL-GUIDE owns the corpus, normalization, translation, non-authority, review, and answer conventions that apply here. Claim-local qualifications remain beside the affected material; check received wording against the course-wide passage inventory.

Any installed snapshot is a working study held from release until its exact bytes and outstanding distribution gates receive separate authorization.

CHAPTER 2

References

The following works are the course's controlling corpus and reference aids. Project-composed explanation, translation, analysis, exercises, and models are distinguished from received wording under the convention stated in the Scope and Qualifications appendix. Short source passages are identified so that the learner can verify their wider context. The adjacent edition manifest and passage inventory record exact source roles, checks, access states, and known rights limits.

2.1 Primary corpus

- Catholic Church, *Missale Romanum ex decreto SS. Concilii Tridentini restitutum, Summorum Pontificum cura recognitum*, editio typica (Rome, 1962). A searchable presentation of the edition is hosted by the Holy See's Biblia Clerus project: <https://www.clerus.org/bibliaclerusonline/EN/gmb.htm>.
- A page-image scan of the 1962 typical edition is available through the Church Music Association of America: <https://media.churchmusicassociation.org/pdf/missale62.pdf>. Page images, rather than unsourced transcriptions, should decide doubtful punctuation or spelling.

- The Clementine Vulgate is the principal biblical comparison corpus. The public-domain 1914 edition edited by Michael Hetzenauer and its provenance are described at <https://www.sacredbible.org/vulgate1914/>.

2.2 Grammar and lexicography

- J. H. Allen and J. B. Greenough, *New Latin Grammar for Schools and Colleges* (1903), a donor-declared public-domain reference whose digital locator was not independently consulted during integration: <https://archive.org/details/allengreenoughsn01alle>.
- Charles E. Bennett, *New Latin Grammar*, 1918 revision, Project Gutenberg eBook 15665; public-domain text in the United States: <https://www.gutenberg.org/ebooks/15665>.
- Charlton T. Lewis and Charles Short, *A Latin Dictionary* (1879), searchable transcription: <https://logeion.uchicago.edu/lexidium>.
- Charles du Fresne, sieur du Cange, *Glossarium mediae et infimae latinitatis*, a donor-declared later-vocabulary aid whose digital locator was not independently consulted during integration: <http://ducange.enc.sorbonne.fr/>.

The underlying 1903, 1918, 1879, and 1883–1887 printed works are public domain in the United States. Digital transcriptions and interfaces retain their own terms and are cited as access tools, not relicensed or reproduced wholesale. The 1962 Missal, Scripture, official text, and other received wording retain their own status; see the scope appendix, research records, and final-page rights notice.

Classical reference grammars describe the inherited system but do not by themselves explain every biblical or ecclesiastical development. The advanced volume therefore distinguishes classical baseline, Vulgate usage, later Christian usage, and stable liturgical formula instead of labeling every difference an “exception.”

2.3 Citation convention

Missal passages are cited by liturgical location and text genre rather than by a page number that varies among printings. Biblical texts are cited by book, chapter, and verse. Historical authors are cited by work and section wherever possible. A learner preparing a formal commentary should verify each passage against the edition actually being used and record any variant. These references are not a claim that every historical-linguistic question can be settled by the listed school grammars and dictionary interfaces.

CHAPTER 3

Generation Metadata

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Model: GPT-5-based Codex agent; unexposed: exact model identifier and model qualifiers

Agent/runtime: OpenAI Codex agents (curriculum architecture, module design, enrichment, source and answer audit, correction, production, and review); Codex CLI 0.144.6; API workspace; unexposed: server revision

Agent/runtime: OpenAI Codex agents (whole-curriculum structure audit, shared typesetting and selection correction, rendered-structure regression checks, production, and review); Codex CLI 0.144.6; API workspace; unexposed: server revision

Agent/runtime: OpenAI Codex agents (whole-curriculum Part-scoped numbering and rendered contents hierarchy correction, rendered contents-geometry regression checking, production, and review); Codex CLI 0.144.6; API workspace; unexposed: server revision

Agent/runtime: OpenAI Codex agents (starter-guide consolidation, module-flow and definition-retrieval revision, stage-boundary assessment correction, catalog and audit records, production, and review); Codex CLI 0.144.6; API workspace; unexposed: server revision

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